

INTRODUCTION TO PHILOSOPHY

Knowledge, Minds, and Morality

PHI 205, North Carolina State University

This is my model syllabus for Introduction to Philosophy. Details regarding schedule, assignments, and instruments of evaluation will vary between terms.

INSTRUCTOR

William A. Bauer, Ph.D.

Teaching Assistant Professor of Philosophy

Office location: 434A Withers Hall

Office Hours: T/H 12-1 p.m., W 9-10 a.m. (will vary between terms), or by appointment

Office phone: 919-515-6330 Email: wabauer@ncsu.edu

It is best to contact me by email, especially during non-office hours. Feel free to call during office hours, but please don't leave voice-mail messages as I might not get them; email me instead.

SYLLABUS TABLE OF CONTENTS

1. Course description and goals, p. 1
2. Graded assignments and grading policies, p. 3
3. Course materials, p. 6
4. Course schedule: topics, readings, and assignments, p. 6
5. Course bibliography, p. 10
6. Additional course and University policies and services, p. 10
7. Instructor mini biography, p. 13

COURSE DESCRIPTION AND GOALS

Overview of the Course

In this course we will examine philosophical arguments and theories concerning the scope and nature of human knowledge of the external world, problems of identity over time, the metaphysics of mind, the existence of God, free will, morality, and justice. As you become familiar with major arguments and theories you will also learn to communicate more precisely and critically about the aforementioned issues. If you work hard you will be able to make connections between different philosophical theories, and come to better understand and develop your own theories through critical reflection.

My expectation is that you will also come to have a genuine passion for asking philosophical questions and seeking answers to them. This is important because philosophy examines the most fundamental questions about the nature of existence, knowledge, and morality—questions that have haunted human beings for thousands of years, and will continue to do so. Philosophical questions should not be set aside—we confront them every day either indirectly or directly.

Course Goals

The goals of this course are to increase your capacity to analyze and employ concepts, as well as critique and develop arguments, relevant to questions about the nature of knowledge, the mind, personal identity, the existence of God, free will, morality, and justice. You should come to better understand opposing philosophical views and critically develop your own views by (i) expanding your knowledge of

various perspectives and arguments concerning these issues, (ii) becoming acquainted with various methods of philosophical analysis and argumentation, (iii) discussing these issues, and (iv) being examined on these issues.

Detailed Description of the Course

The course has four major units organized around central problems of philosophy. In Unit 1, on logic and problems of knowledge, we will look at the nature of valid arguments by examining two valid forms of reasoning and two invalid forms of reasoning. We will also discuss a useful technique for analyzing arguments. Then, we will do some epistemology (or, the theory of knowledge) by investigating whether humans can have knowledge of the external world (i.e., the mind-independent world). The first topic is Cartesian skepticism (as formulated by Rene Descartes) about knowledge of the external world, and how such skepticism might be overcome. We will also examine selections from two great empiricists, John Locke (who affirms the reality of material objects) and George Berkeley (who denies the reality of material objects).

Elements of Locke's and Berkeley's theories go beyond epistemology and make metaphysical claims and assumptions, or claims about the nature of reality. Metaphysical questions probe the nature of reality beyond the scope of full scientific investigation, and we will discuss a number of metaphysical problems and their ramifications for our understanding of the world and persons.

In Unit 2, we focus on persons and minds. We will explore the problem of personal identity over time: just what *is* a person, and what makes a person the same person over time? Since persons are part of the larger class of existing objects, it will be worth our time to ask what makes any object the same object over time. And what do we mean by "the same"? Related to questions of personal identity, we will also look closely at the mind-body problem, the central metaphysical problem regarding the mind. Is the mind material or immaterial? Does the mind interact with the body? Can machines understand or think? We will read and discuss classic selections from Descartes and Aristotle, as well as influential contemporary articles by Derek Parfit and John Searle.

In Unit 3, we turn our attention to one of the most discussed philosophical questions: does God exist? What do we mean by 'God'? Our focus, as in all of philosophy, is on examining rational arguments for and against the claim that God exists. Hence, our study of this topic will not directly touch upon questions of faith or questions about the justification for a particular religious point of view. Instead, we will restrict our objective examination to the existence of a single, all-powerful being, so our efforts will primarily be relevant to monotheistic traditions. We will discuss two classic arguments for God's existence and examine in detail the problem of evil.

Lastly, in Unit 4 we study the nature of free will and morality. After investigating the relationship between free will, determinism, and moral responsibility, we will look at a major challenge to morality discussed by Plato. Then we will examine some highly influential moral theories, including Mill's Utilitarianism, Kant's moral theory, and Aristotle's virtue theory. These theories have had a lasting, profound impact on ethics and provide a useful starting point for ethical decision-making. To end the course, we will discuss two theories of distributive justice, thus shifting the focus from questions about the morality of individuals' actions to questions about the morality of social and political actions. The central problem concerns how goods should be distributed in society to create a 'just' state.

Important: Respect, Discussion, and Points of View

1. I ask that all class members respect the rights of other class members to express their points of view about the controversial issues we will discuss. It is highly desirable in studying and doing philosophy that significant class discussion occur; to that end, you are encouraged to express your reasoned opinions, questions, and comments during class at any time. If your tone or

demeanor becomes disrespectful to others in class, you may be asked to leave the room. (But I don't expect any of this to be an issue.)

2. A good portion of many meetings will consist of the instructor presenting analyses of key arguments and claims from articles that the class has read, and filling in key background facts and concepts. But these presentations are intended to be informal and you are encouraged to ask questions and bring up interesting points of view at any time.
3. I will not be teaching my own theories or arguments that I favor, but those that have been espoused or formulated by other philosophers. Furthermore, I will make a concerted effort to not even indicate my positions on issues in or out of class. This policy is meant to maximize the objectivity of your explorations in the course.
4. There will be times when I place you in small peer groups to discuss some concept or argument, and you should use this time to share your perspective and form further questions. Your participation in these small group discussions is expected, but is not graded. Again, good discussion can only help in learning course material and in understanding your own views.
5. I will occasionally conduct informal surveys (simply asking for a show of hands) on various topics in order to bring out different points of view; this is, of course, voluntary but it is extremely helpful in generating discussion and appreciating different points of view.
6. Please do not browse the internet or do non-course related activities on laptops or smartphones. This is distracting to other students and the instructor. If you prefer to take notes on your favored electronic device, do so as discreetly and quietly as possible (but please do **not** make audio recordings of classroom discussion or commentary—if doing so is necessary as deemed by the Disability Services Office, please see me first). If your use of electronic devices in class is distracting or disrespectful, you may be asked to exit the room.

General Education Program (GEP) objectives and student learning outcomes

Successful completion of PHI 205 (Introduction to Philosophy) satisfies 3 credit hours of the 6-hour Humanities GEP requirement. Credit is not allowed for both PHI 205 and PHI 210.

Because this course satisfies 3 credit hours of the 6-hour Humanities GEP requirement, it “will provide instruction and guidance that help students to:

1. Engage the human experience through the interpretation of human culture and
2. Become aware of the act of interpretation itself as a critical form of knowing in the humanities; and
3. Make academic arguments about the human experience using reasons and evidence for supporting those reasons that are appropriate to the humanities.” (Quoted from the Office of Undergraduate Courses and Curricula, <http://oucc.ncsu.edu/gep-hum>)

GRADED ASSIGNMENTS AND GRADING PROCEDURES

Grade components and percentages – SUMMARY (see further details below)

5 quizzes: 60 points (12 points each)

These are scattered throughout the course, with at least one in each unit.

2 philosophical problems worksheets: 30 points (15 points each)

One will be completed covering Units 1 and 2, and one covering Unit 4.

Midterm exam: 30 points

This covers units 1 and 2.

Final exam: 30 points

This is non-cumulative, covering units 3 and 4.

Total points possible: 150

Course Grading Scale

The 150-point scale below assigns letter grades according to traditional percentages: A's in the 90-100% range, B's in the 80-89% range, C's in the 70-79% range, D's in the 60-69% range, and F's at or below 59%.

Numerical total	Letter grade
146-150	A+
139-145	A
135-138	A-
131-134	B+
124-130	B
120-123	B-
116-119	C+
109-115	C
105-108	C-
101-104	D+
94-100	D
90-93	D-
0-91	F

The quizzes – further details

You will take five quizzes on various topics throughout the course, designed to assess your understanding of core concepts and arguments, and challenge you to apply these in both short essay format and multiple choice scenarios. A study guide will be provided for the quizzes.

The exams – further details

The exams are designed to assess your understanding of the core concepts, arguments, and theories that we study, and how all of these relate to each other. Exam questions are formed on the basis of the assigned readings, handouts, and class commentary. I aim to mainly ask questions that reflect material that was covered both in the readings *and* in the class meetings. Some questions will be *factual or definitional*, such as 'what does X mean?' or 'who maintains that X is the case?' or 'what claim does this argument support?' Other questions will be *inferential*, such as 'if X is true, then does Y or Z follow?' or 'is it true that Z is objection to Y?' or 'is it true that reason X supports claim Y?' This is not an exhaustive list of types of questions, just a snapshot. There will be in-class reviews for both exams (these might be brief, depending on what remains to be covered before the exams). A study guide will be provided for each exam.

Philosophical Problems worksheets – further details

You will complete 2 philosophical problems worksheets worth 15 points each. One will be completed covering Units 1 and 2 (on logic, knowledge, and personal identity), and one covering Unit 4 (on moral theory and free will). These consist of short discussion questions, quiz-style questions, and reflection questions prompting you to synthesize information, criticize a theory, or form an argument. We will discuss the worksheets in class, you'll discuss certain problems on them in small groups, and then you'll have until the next meeting to complete them.

Final grades

For the final course grade, the total points earned for quizzes, exams, and worksheets will be added and letter grades assigned according to the scale above. You can determine where you stand at any given point by dividing your points earned by points possible up to that point to; the percent will give you a good indicator of your current letter grade.

Attendance

I will record attendance for every meeting, but this is not a formal component of your grade. So, poor attendance will not formally harm your grade. But excellent attendance can, of course, only help your performance and make the course more interesting and valuable for everyone if you contribute to discussion. Good attendance tends to be associated with stronger performance on quizzes and exams. Can good attendance warrant a bump up in grade? Sometimes it occurs that an individual's final grade approaches very closely the next highest grade (e.g., within 1 point) and in this case a small bump might be justified. However, if this situation arises, a reasonable cut-off point will be determined for the class and applied equitably to all individuals that had *good* attendance, defined as not having missed more than two classes (excluding officially excused absences due to medical reasons, religious observances, University business, or other appropriate reasons as specified in the regulation referenced at the end of this passage). The best thing to do is work hard to get the scores you desire. Attendance, participation, hard work, and sincere interest in the topics will pay off both in terms of grades and, most importantly, learning. Please see University policy on attendance at <http://policies.ncsu.edu/regulation/reg-02-20-03>, which will be enforced (including the Drop for Non-Attendance Policy).

Make-ups

Make-up exams and quizzes are not allowed without prior arrangement with the instructor, and are only allowed for reasons specified by University policy (see the previous paragraph). Measures are taken to ensure that there are no assignments or exams on days of verifiable religious observance; however, if a verifiable conflict remains for you, please contact the instructor as early as possible to establish other arrangements. Late assignments (e.g., the worksheets, or missed exams for which you did *not* coordinate with the instructor to miss) will receive a 2-point penalty for each day late.

Academic integrity on coursework

All students are required to follow the standards of academic honesty as stated in the NC State Code of Student Conduct. Plagiarism is a serious ethical violation, and instances of plagiarism may lead to failure of the course. On exams and quizzes, you are required to sign the following statement signifying that you have received no unauthorized aid: "I have neither given nor received unauthorized aid on this test or assignment." Penalties for violations will range from grade-reduction to failure of the course; infringements will be reported to the Office of Student Conduct. Be familiar with the Code of Student Conduct, as outlined at <http://studentconduct.ncsu.edu/policies-and-procedures>, which addresses

academic integrity and other important issues. The official policy is viewable at:
<http://policies.ncsu.edu/policy/pol-11-35-01>.

COURSE MATERIALS

Nearly all the journal articles and book chapters assigned are classic philosophical pieces, either from the history of philosophy (ancient and modern eras) or recent contemporary essays that have had a significant impact. So you will not be reading textbook stuff, but original, influential philosophical works.

(1) **Selected articles and chapters found *Knowledge, Nature, and Norms: An Introduction to Philosophy*, edited by Mark Timmons and David Shoemaker (Wadsworth Cengage 2009).**

(Price at NC State bookstore: used \$53.95; you might want to check online bookstores, where it is usually available for much less than this.)

(2) **Journal articles, book chapters, and other resources on e-reserve or online.** All of these are accessible through Moodle, <http://moodle.wolfware.ncsu.edu/>. In some cases, when you click on the link you will be taken to e-reserves, <https://reserves.lib.ncsu.edu/>, so you will have to log in again at that site to access the resource (these are all reviewed by library staff for uploading in e-reserves). In the other cases, you will be taken to an article or resource freely accessible online. A bibliography of these supplemental resources can be found after the Course Schedule below.

(3) **Handouts, study guides, and other course materials.** Instructor-created handouts will typically be available in class as hard copies, and placed on Moodle as well. Study guides for the quizzes and exams will be available on Moodle.

COURSE SCHEDULE: TOPICS, READINGS, AND ASSIGNMENTS

Nearly all reading assignments are from *Knowledge, Nature, and Norms*, edited by M. Timmons and D. Shoemaker; see the table of contents in the book for page numbers of assigned selections. Other readings are accessible through electronic reserves (linked in Moodle) at the NC State library.

It is important to note that the list of readings below does not indicate all the material you need to be familiar with to do well. Class meetings are designed to complement the assigned readings. For all topics, there are background concepts and distinctions necessary for adequately understanding the material that will only be introduced in class.

All handouts will be discussed in class—they form the basis of instructor commentary on the given topic or reading, and are designed to highlight key points and arguments from readings, as well as give helpful background. When no handout is used, notes will be made on the white board that serve the same function as the handout; even when handouts are used, diagrams that complement them will be introduced in class.

You are responsible for being familiar with material both from the readings and our discussions. I intend for the majority of quiz and exam questions to reflect material that is both covered in class *and* discussed in the readings.

Recommended sequence of activities to maximize your success

Before class: complete the required reading (also read the short editors' introductions found at the beginning of assigned readings from the anthology, which provide helpful background information and succinctly summarize the articles); try to identify the author's main claim and overall argument for that claim.

In class: listen to instructor commentary and follow handout/notes concerning the theory or argument under consideration, ask questions, raise objections, discuss key claims with peers (when a small-group activity is assigned), etc.

After class: reflect on the theory or argument explored, study notes/handouts, and use quiz and exam study guides to organize your studying.

The instructor reserves the right to make changes to the schedule as necessary for the benefit of the class as a whole. Any changes will promptly be announced in class or through email.

UNIT 1: LOGIC AND PROBLEMS OF KNOWLEDGE
--

This schedule is based on two 1.25-hour meetings per week over fifteen weeks.

Main topic: (i) philosophical questions; (ii) basic logic – part 1

Required reading: this entire syllabus

Main topic: basic logic – part 2

Required reading: Timmons and Shoemaker, "Introduction" (pp. 1-16, especially pp. 6-11)

Main topic: skepticism about knowledge of the external world

Required reading: Descartes, "Within the Sphere of the Doubtful" (focus especially on Meditation I, pp. 285-288; in Timmons and Shoemaker)

QUIZ #1 (on logic and skepticism, 15 minutes at the start of class)

Main topics: (i) Locke on perception and qualities; (ii) Locke on knowledge of the external world

Required reading: Locke, "The Causal Theory of Perception" (on e-reserve, through Moodle)

Main topics: (i) finish Locke on knowledge of the external world; (ii) Berkeley on perception

Required reading: Berkeley, "On the Principles of Human Knowledge" (e-reserve, through Moodle)

Main topic: (i) Berkeley on perception; (ii) Berkeley's argument against the existence of external objects

Reading: Berkeley, "On the Principles of Human Knowledge" (e-reserve, through Moodle)

QUIZ # 2 (on Locke and Berkeley, 15 minutes at the start of class)

Main topic: Moore's response to skepticism

Required reading: Moore, "Certainty" (in Timmons and Shoemaker)

UNIT 2: PUZZLES OF PERSONAL IDENTITY AND THE MIND-BODY PROBLEM

Main topic: a puzzle about the identity of objects over time

Required reading: none assigned

Main topic: the same consciousness theory of personal identity

Required reading: Locke, "The Prince and the Cobbler" (in Timmons and Shoemaker)

Main topic: why personal identity might not matter

Required reading: Parfit, "The Unimportance of Identity" (in Timmons and Shoemaker)

Worksheet: Logic, Knowledge, and Identity (discuss and begin in class)

Required reading: none assigned

Main topics: introduction to the mind-body problem; Cartesian dualism

Required reading: Descartes, "Meditation II: Of the Nature of the Human Mind, and That It is More Easily Known than the Body" (pp. 288-289, in Timmons and Shoemaker)

QUIZ # 3 (on identity and mind, 15 minutes at start of class)

Main topics: (i) Aristotle's materialist monism; (ii) the 'Chinese Room' thought experiment

Required reading: Aristotle, *On the Soul*, Book II, Part 1 (online, through Moodle) Searle, "Minds, Brains, and Machines" (focus on part II, pp. 119-126, in Timmons and Shoemaker)

Main topic: (i) continue Searle; (ii) review for Midterm Exam

Required reading: none assigned

MIDTERM EXAM (covers Units 1 and 2)

UNIT 3: THE PROBLEM OF THE EXISTENCE OF GOD

Main topic: the ontological argument

Required readings: St. Anselm, "The Ontological Argument" & Gaunilo, "The Lost Island Objection" (in Timmons and Shoemaker)

Main topic: the teleological argument (a.k.a., the argument from design)

Required reading: Paley, "The Teleological Argument" (in Timmons and Shoemaker)

Main topics: (i) continue the teleological argument; (ii) Pascal's wager

Required reading: (i) Pascal, "The Wager" (in Timmons and Shoemaker); (ii) Blackburn, "God" (read only the "Infini—Rien" section, pp. 246-248) (in Timmons and Shoemaker)

Main topic: the problem of evil

Required reading: (i) Hume, "The Problem of Evil" (in Timmons and Shoemaker); (ii) Dostoevsky, "Rebellion" (in Timmons and Shoemaker)

Main topic: continue the problem of evil; free will, determinism, & responsibility – intro comments
Required reading: Stump, “The Mirror of Evil” (in Timmons and Shoemaker)

QUIZ # 4 (on the existence of God, 15 minutes at the start of class)

UNIT 4: PROBLEMS OF FREE WILL AND MORALITY

Main topic: free will, determinism, & responsibility – part 1

Required reading: van Inwagen, “The Powers of Rational Beings: Freedom of the Will” (on e-reserve, through Moodle)

Main topic: (i) free will, determinism, & responsibility – part 2; (ii) egoism and the nature of justice

Required reading: Plato, “The Myth of Gyges” (in Timmons and Shoemaker)

Main topics: (i) cultural relativism as a moral theory; (ii) divine command theory

Required reading: before meeting, read handouts on both (i) and (ii) (available on Moodle)

Main topics: Mill’s utilitarianism – part 1

Required reading: Mill, “In Defense of Utilitarianism” (in Timmons and Shoemaker)

Main topic: (i) Mill’s utilitarianism – part 2; (ii) Kant’s categorical imperative

Required reading: Kant, “The Moral Law and Autonomy of the Will” (in Timmons and Shoemaker)

QUIZ # 5 (on free will and moral theory, 15 minutes at the start of class)

Main topic: (i) continue Kant’s categorical imperative; (ii) Aristotle’s virtue theory

Required reading: Aristotle, “Virtue and Character” (in Timmons and Shoemaker)

Worksheet: Moral Problems: Comparing Ethical Theories (discuss and begin in class)

Required reading: none assigned

Main topics: (i) the original position and patterned theories of distributive justice; (ii) introduction to the historical model of distributive justice

Required reading: Rawls, selections from *A Theory of Justice* (on e-reserve, through Moodle)

Main topic: (i) the historical model of distributive justice; (ii) moral theory and free will: putting it all together (review for the Final Exam)

Required reading: Nozick, selections from *Anarchy, State, and Utopia* (on e-reserve, through Moodle)

FINAL EXAM (covers Units 3 and 4)

BIBLIOGRAPHY OF WORKS ON E-RESERVE OR ONLINE*

*Bibliographic information for selections in the Timmons and Shoemaker anthology can be found on the first page of each selection.

Aristotle. 350 B.C.E. *On the Soul*. Trans. J.A. Smith. <http://classics.mit.edu/Aristotle/soul.html>.

Berkeley, George. 2011. "Of the Principles of Human Knowledge." In *Reason and Responsibility: Readings in Some Basic Problems of Philosophy*, 14th edition, eds. Joel Feinberg and Russ Shafer-Landau. Boston: Wadsworth, pp. 223-230. [Berkeley's *A Treatise Concerning the Principles of Human Knowledge*, from which this selection is taken, was originally published in 1710.]

Locke, John. 2011. "The Causal Theory of Perception." In *Reason and Responsibility: Readings in Some Basic Problems of Philosophy*, 14th edition, eds. Joel Feinberg and Russ Shafer-Landau. Boston: Wadsworth, pp. 215-222. [Locke's *An Essay Concerning Human Understanding*, from which this selection is taken, was originally published in 1690.]

Nozick, Robert. 2006. Selection from *Anarchy, State, and Utopia*. In *Today's Moral Issues: Classic and Contemporary Perspectives*, 5th Edition, Daniel Bonevac, New York: McGraw Hill, pp. 517-524. [Nozick's *Anarchy, State, and Utopia* was originally published in 1974 by Basic Books.]

Rawls, John. 2006. Selection from *A Theory of Justice*. In *Today's Moral Issues: Classic and Contemporary Perspectives*, 5th Edition, Daniel Bonevac, New York: McGraw Hill, pp. 511-516. [Rawls' *A Theory of Justice* was originally published in 1971 by Harvard University Press.]

Van Inwagen, Peter. 2008. *The Powers of Rational Beings: Freedom of the Will*. In van Inwagen's *Metaphysics*. Westview Press.

ADDITIONAL COURSE AND UNIVERSITY POLICIES AND SERVICES

Communication: I encourage maximal discussion of course topics both in and out of class. You are encouraged to share your questions, views, and reasoning behind your views at any point during class meetings. I aim to respond to email messages within 24 hours, but will keep my responses to questions succinct. As a general rule, try to avoid asking detailed questions about course content in an email; such questions are best presented in person, because the conversation will probably be more productive and efficient. However, email is the best way to set up a time to meet if you cannot meet during office hours, or if you have a relatively minor question. Visiting during office hours is a great way to review material and ask questions.

Discussing grades with the instructor: I am always willing to discuss your grades on assignments/exams, and reviewing your performance with me is a good way to make progress in the future. If you wish to contest your grade on an assignment me, do not expect an increase of your grade unless it is clear that a verifiable, numerical mistake was made. When this is not the case, and you believe there was a misjudgment of the quality of your assignment (on an essay question), it is advisable to not make a case for more points unless you believe that the assigned grade is off significantly. I am always willing to hear what you have to say, but complaints over one point are not likely to be successful.

University Grading Policies: The following policies, extracted from University regulation and policy, will be enforced in addition to those specific to this course as discussed earlier in the Syllabus under Grading Procedures and Policies. University regulation governs grading and grade point averages, and is available at: <http://policies.ncsu.edu/regulation/reg-02-50-03>.

Incomplete grades (IN)

Here is some specific (though not comprehensive) information about incomplete grades (for complete information, see the website listed above). "IN" is a temporary grade, and must be made up by the end of the next semester. As specified in the University regulation: "An IN is only appropriate when the student's record in the course is such that the successful completion of particular assignments, projects, or tests missed as a result of a documented serious event would enable that student to pass the course. Work undertaken to make up the IN grade must be limited to the completion of the missed work."

Audits

Please see me if this applies to you. University regulation about audits is available at <http://policies.ncsu.edu/regulation/reg-02-20-04>, and will apply.

Credit-only courses

"The student's performance in a credit-only course will be reported as S (satisfactory grade for credit-only course and given when course work is equivalent to C- or better) or U (no credit grade for credit-only course). The grade for a credit-only course will have no effect on the student's grade point average. Credit hours for the credit-only course will be counted in the cumulative hours attempted." (The statement is from official University policy.)

See <http://policies.ncsu.edu/regulation/reg-02-20-15> for further details.

Code of Student Conduct: The Code of Student Conduct, as outlined by the Office of Student Conduct, is at <http://studentconduct.ncsu.edu/policies-and-procedures>. The complete policy is at <http://policies.ncsu.edu/policy/pol-11-35-01>, addressing academic integrity and other important issues.

Students with special needs: Students requiring assistance due to special circumstances should contact the instructor as soon as possible. "Reasonable accommodations will be made for students with verifiable disabilities. In order to take advantage of these accommodations, students must register with Disability Services Office (<http://www.ncsu.edu/dso>) located at the Student Health Center, 1900 Student Health Center, Campus Box 7509, 515-7653. For more information on NC State's policy on working with students with disabilities, see the Academic Accommodations for Students with Disabilities Regulation" (this statement is from official university policy).

Equality of opportunity: "NC State University provides equality of opportunity in education and employment for all students and employees. Accordingly, NC State affirms its commitment to maintain a work environment for all employees and an academic environment for all students that is free from all forms of discrimination. Discrimination based on race, color, religion, creed, sex, national origin, age, disability, veteran status, or sexual orientation is a violation of state and federal law and/or NC State University policy and will not be tolerated. Harassment of any person (either in the form of quid pro quo or creation of a hostile environment) based on race, color, religion, creed, sex, national origin, age, disability, veteran status, or sexual orientation also is a violation of state and federal law and/or NC State University policy and will not be tolerated. Retaliation against any person who complains about discrimination is also prohibited. NC State's policies and regulations governing discrimination, harassment, and retaliation may be accessed at http://www.ncsu.edu/policies/campus_environ or http://www.ncsu.edu/equal_op. Any person who feels that he or she has been the subject of prohibited

discrimination, harassment, or retaliation should contact the Office for Equal Opportunity (OEO) at 515-3148" (statement from official university policy).

Philosophy, Careers, and Further Studies: From time to time, I might forward information about scholarship opportunities, graduate opportunities, etc., to the class. Additionally, I am happy to discuss with any of you how philosophy connects with various career paths, or about further undergraduate or graduate studies in philosophy. Furthermore, here is a statement from CHASS Career Services that may be of interest: "Exploring career options with your major, making decisions about your major or minor, building resumes and cover letters, preparing for interviews, developing job search strategies, maximizing career fairs, and more." Call 515-2396. University Career Center, 2100 Pullen Hall, www.ncsu.edu/career.

Class Evaluations: Your feedback about the course and the instruction is valuable. I might ask for informal feedback along the way about specific materials or activities in order to make appropriate adjustments to this and further courses (e.g., I might ask for a show of hands of those who found certain materials valuable—no such participation is required, but is helpful). Formal, end-of-course evaluations will be conducted per NC State University policies. Here is the official University statement regarding class evaluations: "Online class evaluations will be available for students to complete during the last week of summer Session I and become unavailable before finals begin: 12 p.m. April 15 through 8 a.m. May 1. Students will receive an email message directing them to a website where they can login using their Unity ID and complete evaluations. All evaluations are confidential; instructors will not know how any one student responded to any question, and students will not know the ratings for any instructors." Evaluation website: <https://classeval.ncsu.edu/> Student help desk: classeval@ncsu.edu More information about ClassEval: <http://www.ncsu.edu/UPA/classeval/>

Student grievances: Please see University regulation: <http://policies.ncsu.edu/regulation/reg-11-40-01>.

Adverse Weather Policy: Check <http://www.ncsu.edu/> for updates on the University's open/closed status, or call 919-513-8888. For the policy on Adverse Weather and Other Emergency Conditions, please see <http://policies.ncsu.edu/regulation/reg-04-20-07>.

Restriction on Sharing Content of Course Materials: Please see University policy on this matter at <http://policies.ncsu.edu/regulation/reg-01-25-02>.

Recording lectures and discussion: "Students may not use recording devices in the classroom without explicit prior permission of the instructor. If permission is granted, there must also be no member of the class who objects. Instructor and class permission is not required when an accommodation notification from Disability Services has been received by the instructor, which identifies a student that requires the use of a recording device. However, the instructor may prohibit the use of any recording device when it would inhibit free discussion and free exchange of ideas in the classroom" (statement from University policy at <http://policies.ncsu.edu/regulation/reg-02-20-11>).

Privacy: "Students may be required to disclose personally identifiable information to other students in the course, including via electronic tools like email or web--postings, where relevant to the course. Examples include online discussions of class topics, and posting of student coursework. All students are expected to respect one another's privacy by not sharing or using such information outside the course." (This statement is from a *proposed* 2008 revision to University regulation, and is implied by current

policies. I do not foresee any online forums being used for this course, or any need for student coursework to be posted for such forums, though you will be asked to share your ideas and perspectives in class, e.g., in small-group discussions).

See University regulation at: <http://policies.ncsu.edu/regulation/reg-08-00-11>.

Furthermore: “All students in this class are expected to respect the privacy of their classmates by (1) not revealing course work and course identities outside the classroom, especially sensitive information, and (2) by refraining from publicly sharing information (e.g., assignments, exams, and creative work, etc.) to which you have access as a member of the class.” (This statement is approved by the Office of the General Counsel).

WILLIAM BAUER – MINI BIOGRAPHY

I joined the Department of Philosophy and Religious Studies at NC State in the fall of 2010. So far at NC State, I have taught Introduction to Philosophy and Bio-Medical Ethics. Previously, I was at the University of Nebraska-Lincoln where I completed my doctoral studies in Philosophy and taught for five years. Before that, I studied Philosophy at Miami University-Oxford, Ohio, served in the US Army Medical Service Corps, and completed a degree in Biology at Illinois Institute of Technology (Chicago). My primary areas of research and teaching interest include metaphysics, philosophy of science, and bioethics. At NC State, I have taught both Introduction to Philosophy and Bio-Medical Ethics. I enjoy discussions with everyone taking my courses, both in and out of class, and I am committed to sharing the concepts and analytical tools necessary to make progress on important philosophical questions.